

Rise & Shine Morning Routine

Myth Busting

- A good start is more than half the battle. Many of you might think that you have a missing ingredient from your morning routine in order to arrive at the office like ‘annoyingly chirpy’ early bird Alice. However, we will begin this journey with a different outlook.
- The Dalai Lama describes the pursuit of happiness as not only pursuing the things that make us happy but eliminating the things which make us unhappy. We often make the mistake in the Western world of overly focusing on the former outlook, we will take the Dalai Lama’s advice by placing more importance on what we can cut from your morning routine which is causing stress.
- Research shows that cutting the usual (alarming) news from the earliest part of your day and replacing it with a more empowering/uplifting news clip gives you an 88% greater likelihood of reporting a good day 8-hours later. Mull over that for a few moments.

Useful Thought Experiments

- Are you making the morning process more difficult than it needs to be? Do you always put your keys back in the same place to ensure you won’t need to go looking for them? Could you prepare your overnight oats the evening before? A successful morning routine looks to minimise decisions and distractions to keep our energy stores nice and high going in to our working day.
- Angela Merkel, Barack Obama and Mark Zuckerberg all reduced their wardrobe options which would have eliminated yet another decision from their morning routine i.e. what am I going to wear today?
- If you want to try and get up earlier then ask yourself if I had an hour which nobody else had in the morning but I had to use it to work on a passion project then what would it be? This can be fuel to get up earlier so you can dedicate some time to this even if it’s only 15-minutes. A whole lot of 15-minutes added up might amaze you as to how far you could get.

What To Cut Out?

- Three things to cut out as much as possible – an alarming alarm, social media/email and news. Consider a dawn simulator or linking a nice song via Bluetooth as your alarm, an infinitely more pleasurable way to wake up. Email and social media make us feel immediately under pressure as we feel like time is shrinking and we already have many more decisions to make – this is energy depleting. According to IDC (International Data Corporation) research, 80% of smartphone users check their phones within 15 minutes of waking up – could these moments be spent more positively and productively?

